

Question:

A 34-year-old poultry worker presents to his physician with a sore throat and a non-productive cough for 2 weeks. His cough is associated with fever. The vital signs include: blood pressure 120/80 mm Hg, heart rate 67/min, respiratory rate 18/min, and temperature 37.6°C (98.0°F). Physical examination shows oropharyngeal erythema and scattered, moist rales on lung auscultation. The patient’s X-ray demonstrates patchy reticular opacities in the perihilar regions of both lungs. After some additional tests, he is diagnosed with community-acquired pneumonia and is treated with cephalexin with modest improvement. Which of the following best describes the immune response elicited by the pathogen that is causing this patient’s condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. It activates TLR5 on the surface of macrophages.
- B. It primarily induces the Th1-cell response.
- C. Peptidoglycan is its major antigen that induces an immune response.
- D. This pathogen evades the immune response by encapsulation.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
To determine the immune response elicited by the pathogen causing the patient's condition , we need to consider the characteristics of the pathogen and the symptoms presented . The patient has been diagnosed with community -acquired pneumonia , which is often caused by bacteria such as Streptococcus pneumoniae . This type of pneumonia typically involves a robust inflammatory response , and the symptoms suggest a bacterial infection . The pathogen in question likely triggers an immune response that involves the activation of various immune cells and the production of cytokines . Considering the symptoms and the treatment with cephalexin , a beta -lactam antibiotic , it is likely that the pathogen is a Gram -positive bacterium , such as Streptococcus pneumoniae . Gram -positive bacteria have a thick peptidoglycan cell wall , which is a major antigen that can induce an immune response . This suggests that the correct answer is related to the peptidoglycan antigen .</think><answer> C . Peptidoglycan is its major antigen that induces an immune response .

